

Agent Procurement Questions

A focused list of questions procurement and security teams can use when vendors claim their agents are production ready.

AUDIENCE

Procurement, security, platform leadership

USE IN

9 min

BEST NEXT STEP

Turn answers into a challenge pack and gate.

Evaluation Method

- 1 Can we run the agent on our own challenge pack and private data?
- 2 Can we compare it against our current baseline under identical tools?
- 3 Can we repeat the same run after model, prompt, or harness changes?

Evidence Access

- 1 Do we get replay, artifacts, and scorecards for failed cases?
- 2 Which evidence is hidden because the vendor hosts the agent?
- 3 Can audit teams export redacted evidence for committee review?

Control And Policy

- 1 Can tool permissions, network access, and secrets be scoped per workload?
- 2 Can cost and latency limits block a release automatically?
- 3 Can failures become permanent regression tests?

Commercial Fit

- 1 Are LLM tokens marked up or bring-your-own-key?
- 2 What happens to replay retention after the pilot?
- 3 Can we self-host or use dedicated infrastructure if required?

How to use this in AgentClash

Pick one workflow, freeze it as a challenge pack, record a baseline run, compare the candidate under the same tools and budget, then promote critical misses into CI release gates.